

12 Angry Men

12 Angry Men, by Sidney Lumet, may be the most radical courtroom drama in cinema history. A behind-closed-doors look at the American legal system that is as riveting as it is spare, this iconic adaptation of Reginald Rose's teleplay stars Henry Fonda as the dissenting member on a jury of white men ready to pass judgment on a Puerto Rican teenager charged with murdering his father. The result is a saga of epic proportions that plays out over a tense afternoon in one sweltering room. Lumet's electrifying snapshot of 1950s America on the verge of change is one of the great feature film debuts.

BLU-RAY SPECIAL EDITION FEATURES

- New high-definition digital restoration, with uncompressed monaural soundtrack
- Frank Schaffner's 1955 teleplay of *12 Angry Men*, from the series *Studio One*, featuring an introduction by Ron Simon, curator at the Paley Center for Media
- Production history of *12 Angry Men*, from teleplay to big-screen classic
- Archival interviews with director Sidney Lumet
- New interview with screenwriter Walter Bernstein about Lumet
- New interview with Simon about writer Reginald Rose
- *Tragedy in a Temporary Town* (1956), a teleplay directed by Lumet and written by Rose
- New interview with cinematographer John Bailey about director of photography Boris Kaufman
- Original theatrical trailer
- English subtitles for the deaf and hard of hearing
- PLUS: A new essay by writer and law professor Thane Rosenbaum

New cover illustration by Sean Phillips, design by Eric Skillman

RoboCop

Called by Ken Russell “the greatest science-fiction film since *Metropolis*,” controversial director Paul Verhoeven’s *RoboCop* is a special effects-laden cult phenomenon. The film features a resurrected and roboticized hero (Peter Weller) in a new, supercharged cyborg body, struggling to reclaim his memory and avenge his own death. Written by Edward Neumeier and Michael Miner, this film is a grown-up superhero fantasy come to vivid, bloody life.

Film Info

- United States
- 1987
- 103 minutes
- Color
- 1.66:1
- English
- **Spine #23**

DVD SPECIAL EDITION FEATURES

- The unrated director's cut, including "excessively violent" shots cut from the theatrical release to avoid an X rating
- Audio commentary featuring director Paul Verhoeven, co-writer Edward Neumeier, executive producer Jon Davison, and *RoboCop* expert Paul M. Sammon
- Film-to-storyboard comparison
- Storyboards
- An illustrated essay on the making of *RoboCop*
- Theatrical and teaser trailers
- English subtitles for the deaf and hard of hearing
- PLUS: An essay by Carrie Rickey

Cover by David Hutchins and Joseph Negro

Seven Samurai

One of the most thrilling movie epics of all time, *Seven Samurai* (*Shichinin no samurai*) tells the story of a sixteenth-century village whose desperate inhabitants hire the eponymous warriors to protect them from invading bandits. This three-hour-plus ride from Akira Kurosawa—featuring legendary actors Toshiro Mifune and Takashi Shimura—seamlessly weaves philosophy and entertainment, delicate human emotions and relentless action, into a rich, evocative, and unforgettable tale of courage and hope.

4K UHD + BLU-RAY SPECIAL EDITION FEATURES

- New 4K digital restoration, with the original uncompressed monaural soundtrack and an optional 2.0 surround DTS-HD Master Audio soundtrack
- One 4K UHD disc of the film (in the aspect ratio of 1.37:1) and two Blu-rays with the film (in the aspect ratio of 1.33:1) and special features
- Two audio commentaries, one featuring film scholars David Desser, Joan Mellen, Stephen Prince, Tony Rayns, and Donald Richie, and the other Japanese-film expert Michael Jeck
- Making-of documentary, created as part of the Toho Masterworks series *Akira Kurosawa: It Is Wonderful to Create*
- *My Life in Cinema* (1993), a two-hour conversation between director Akira Kurosawa and filmmaker Nagisa Oshima
- “*Seven Samurai*”: *Origins and Influences*, a documentary looking at the samurai traditions and films that helped shape Kurosawa’s masterpiece
- Trailers and teaser
- Gallery of rare posters, behind-the-scenes photos, and production stills
- PLUS: Essays by Kenneth Turan, Peter Cowie, Philip Kemp, Peggy Chiao, Alain Silver, Stuart Galbraith IV, Arthur Penn, and Sidney Lumet, and an interview with actor Toshiro Mifune from 1993

Cover by Neil Kellerhouse

Nanook of the North

Robert Flaherty’s classic film tells the story of Inuit hunter Nanook and his family as they struggle to survive in the harsh conditions of Canada’s Hudson Bay region. Enormously

popular when released in 1922, *Nanook of the North* is a cinematic milestone that continues to enchant audiences. Criterion is proud to present the original director's cut, restored to the proper frame rate and tinted according to Flaherty's personal print.

DVD SPECIAL EDITION FEATURES

- Digital master at the visually correct speed, supervised by preservationist David Shepard
- Orchestral score by silent film music specialist Timothy Brock
- Excerpts from the television documentary *Flaherty and Film*, featuring interviews with the filmmaker's widow and *Nanook* co-editor Frances Flaherty
- Stills gallery of Flaherty's photographs of life in the Arctic
- PLUS: An essay by Dean W. Duncan

Cover by Cynthia Eddy

The Element of Crime

Lars von Trier's stunning debut feature is a grungily expressionistic hallucination—a trancelike trawl through fractured memories, a murder mystery, and the psychic limbo of cultural displacement. From his exile in Cairo, a former police investigator (Michael Elphick) undergoes hypnosis in order to relive his memories of Europe and his last

case, for which he went to dangerous lengths to enter into the mind of and catch a serial killer targeting children. Bathed in a sulfurous yellow glow pierced only by startling flashes of electric blue and red, *The Element of Crime* combines hard-boiled noir, dystopian science fiction, and dazzling operatic flourishes to yield a celluloid nightmare of terrifying beauty.

DIRECTOR-APPROVED BLU-RAY SPECIAL EDITION FEATURES

- 3K digital restoration, approved by director Lars von Trier, with uncompressed monaural soundtrack
- Audio commentaries featuring von Trier, director of photography Tom Elling, editor Tómas Gislason, filmmaker and critic Stig Björkman, and film scholar Peter Schepelern
- *Tranceformer: A Portrait of Lars von Trier*, a 1997 documentary by Björkman
- Making-of documentary from 1984
- Programs featuring interviews with Elling, Gislason, Schepelern, assistant director Åke Sandgren, executive producer Per Holst, production manager Per Årman, and crew members Peter Grant, Birger Larsen, and Henrik Fleischer
- Two short student films by von Trier: *Nocturne* (1980) and *Images of Liberation* (1982)
- Trailer
- English subtitles for the deaf and hard of hearing